doors to all.' In Madhok's telling, he told the Mahasabha that in free India, there was 'no place for any organisation which may be open to followers of only one religion. When Hindu Mahasabha refused to accept his advice, he resigned from it, and formed Jana Sangh'.[132] The early leadership of the Jan Sangh did have minority representation. Its first president of Madras State was the late Dr V.K. John, a devout Roman Catholic. Its secretary in Jammu and Kashmir was Shaikh Abdul Rehman.

Much like L.K. Advani's articulation of it in the 1980s, the Jan Sangh's nationalism, in its view, was meant to be above tokenism: 'Jana Sangh is nationalist not because we have Muslims or Christians among us but because our outlook is nationalist, our thinking is nationalist and our policies are nationalist. We do not believe that coming of Muslims makes us nationalist. Even if there was not a single Muslim in Jana Sangh, even if there was not a single Christian in Jana Sangh, even then the Jana Sangh would be nationalist. It is wrong to think that an organisation becomes nationalist only when people of a particular religion join it. There would be nothing more wrong and irrational, than this approach.'[133]

Early Jan Sangh documents are full of references to 'bharatiya sanskriti' (Indian culture) and Sanskritic terms—Dharma, Artha, Kama and Moksha—as a guiding philosophy for its political ideals. The problem was that it was difficult to quantify what this meant, except a harking back to a golden past.[134] This is what got rolled into what the BJP would later call 'Integral Humanism' in the 1980s. The point the Jan Sangh made was that 'most of the political parties in India are inspired by Western ideologies. They are linked with one or other political movement of the West and are mere replicas of the corresponding institutions there. They cannot fulfil the aspirations of Bharat. Nor can they provide any guidance for a world standing at the cross-roads … They fail to perceive the revolutionary elements in Bharatiya *samskriti …* Integral humanism must necessarily make a balanced approach of both Bharatiya and as well as Western ideologies.'[135]

In Madhok's summing up, 'Rig Veda says: God is one. Wise men call Him by many names. You may call Him Indra or Varuna. You may call Him Ram or Rahim. You may call Him Allah or anything